

The Daily Gamecock: Society & Culture Ideas

Opinion Section

Spring 2026

Student Social Life

1. The Dating Scene at USC

- **Angle:** What's dating like on campus? How do students meet people? What are the challenges?

2. Living with a Roommate for the First Time

- **Pro:** Learning to share space builds communication skills and lifelong friendships.
- **Con:** Incompatible roommates can derail an entire semester.
- **Feature:** Tips and stories from students navigating their first roommate experience.

3. Underclassmen vs. Upperclassmen Experience

- **Angle:** How does the college experience change from freshman to senior year?

4. Reflective Editorials from Seniors

- **Angle:** Seniors looking back on their time at USC—what they learned, what they'd do differently.

5. Why Did You Choose USC?

- **Angle:** Stories from out-of-state students (especially from places like New Jersey) on why they came to South Carolina.

6. Your Life, Your Movie: USC's Main Character Syndrome

- **Pro:** Self-focused mindset can fuel confidence and unique identity-building on campus.
- **Con:** "Main character" attitudes can breed narcissism and neglect genuine community.
- **News Angle:** Social media trends encouraging personal branding and campus influencers.

Greek Life & Organizations

1. Greek Life Rush: Effect on Mental Health

- **Pro:** Rush builds community and creates lifelong bonds.
- **Con:** The pressure and rejection can seriously impact mental health.
- **Feature:** Student stories from both sides of the rush experience.

2. The Importance of Joining Professional Fraternities

- **Angle:** Why professional fraternities are valuable for networking and career development.

3. Appreciating Multicultural Fraternities and Sororities

- **Angle:** Highlighting the contributions and culture of multicultural Greek organizations.

4. Political Polarization Among Campus Clubs

- **Pro:** Healthy debate and political engagement foster critical thinking and active citizenship.

- **Con:** Increased polarization undermines collaboration and civil discourse.
- **News Angle:** Overview of prominent political clubs and upcoming forums.

5. Involvement Gaps: Who's Really Participating in Campus Life?

- **Pro:** Celebrate the breadth of clubs and organizations making involvement accessible.
- **Con:** Cliquish cultures and recruiting methods leave certain demographics out.
- **News Angle:** Membership stats across major clubs and leadership councils.

Mental Health & Wellness

1. USC's Mental Health Services: Substance or Show?

- **Pro:** Commend expanded counseling hours and increased staffing.
- **Con:** Underlying issues remain ignored; resources are inadequate for student population.
- **News Angle:** Range of mental health services available with official usage statistics.

2. Getting Outdoors: Why Students Need to Touch Grass

- **Pro:** Link increased outdoor time to mental health benefits and stress reduction.
- **Con:** Brief outdoor breaks don't help in the face of heavy workloads and tight schedules.
- **News Angle:** Statistics on campus green spaces and nature-themed student events.

3. Chronically Online Culture

- **Angle:** Dependence on social media and its triggering effects on individuals with body image issues or mental health disorders.

4. Is Gen Z Desensitized to Violence?

- **Angle:** From *Saltburn* to the *Dahmer* series—are we becoming numb to explicit content?

5. The Obsession with True Crime Is Concerning

- **Angle:** Why are we so fascinated with murder documentaries? Is it healthy?

Campus Culture & Arts

1. Supporting USC's Music Culture

- **Angle:** Highlight student bands, a cappella groups, and local music scene.

2. Reading Revival: Encouraging Students to Open a Book

- **Pro:** Promote university programs or book clubs that make reading fun and community-oriented.
- **Con:** Busy college life leaves little room for reading that isn't required coursework.
- **News Angle:** Library resources, reading challenge sign-ups, and campus workshop dates.

3. Head-to-Head: North vs. South Cultural Differences

- **Angle:** Driving culture, food preferences, and social norms—what are the biggest differences?

4. Halloween Topics

- Cultural misappropriation in costumes
- The impact of fast fashion on Halloween costumes

Politics & Civic Engagement

1. Where Do Students Get Their News From?

- **Angle:** Social media, traditional outlets, or nowhere at all? Media literacy matters.

2. The Importance of Voting

- **Angle:** Voter education and registration—why it matters for students.

3. Voter Apathy Among Students

- **Pro:** Students are more engaged than ever through new registration drives.
- **Con:** Cynicism and feeling like votes don't matter keeps students home.
- **News Angle:** Registration statistics and upcoming elections.

4. Political Organizations Treated Like Solicitors

- **Angle:** Are campus policies unfair to political clubs trying to engage students?

5. The Endless Debate: Higher Education Politics

- **Pro:** Political clashes can spark meaningful conversation and active campus engagement.
- **Con:** It's all talk with no tangible improvement for students or academic quality.
- **News Angle:** Upcoming political events, guest speakers, and administrative statements.

6. Governor Elections and University Funding

- **Angle:** Remember—the governor decides how much funding the university gets from the state.

7. Age Limits for Members of Congress

- **Pro:** Fresh perspectives and modern understanding require younger representatives.
- **Con:** Experience and institutional knowledge are valuable.

Technology & Media

1. AI Tools in Education

- **Pro:** AI will actually make students smarter—many current studies warning against it are heavily flawed.
- **Con:** AI may undermine learning and create dependency.
- **News Angle:** University policies on AI and how professors are adapting.

2. Data Leaks and Privacy Issues

- **Angle:** How does this growing problem tie into the rise of AI?

3. The Higher-Ed Software Monopoly: USC's Digital Systems

- **Pro:** Consistency of using one platform for learning, attendance, and events.
- **Con:** High licensing costs, technical glitches, and lack of alternatives.
- **News Angle:** Current software solutions and upcoming tech evaluations.

4. Congress Investigating the Wrong Social Media

- **Angle:** The focus on TikTok while Twitter/X issues remain unaddressed.

State & National Issues

1. South Carolina's Education System: A Stalled Future

- **Pro:** Emphasize recent reforms and community engagement efforts.
- **Con:** Lack of funding and short-sighted policies perpetuate poor outcomes.
- **News Angle:** Major education bills under review with quotes from officials.

2. The Gap Between High School and College in SC

- **Angle:** How different schools have vastly different resources—does this prepare students for college?

3. Minimum Wage Increase

- **Pro:** Living wages are essential for working students.
- **Con:** Could lead to job cuts and higher prices.

4. Rent Increases Around Columbia

- **Angle:** How rising rent is affecting students' ability to afford living off-campus.

5. Gun Policies in South Carolina

- **Angle:** Where does SC stand and how does it affect campus safety?

6. Weed Legalization in South Carolina

- **Pro:** Medical benefits, tax revenue, and reduced incarceration.
- **Con:** Public health concerns and federal legal conflicts.

Career & Work

1. How Alumni Feel About Their USC Education

- **Angle:** Did USC prepare them for the job market? What would they change?

2. Internship Challenges: Why Some Majors Struggle More

- **Pro:** Praise departments that partner with local businesses creating internship pipelines.
- **Con:** Lack of campus resources for majors outside traditional in-demand fields.
- **News Angle:** Career fair dates, internship portals, and success stories.

3. Transfer Students at USC: Hidden Hurdles and Solutions

- **Pro:** Support programs that ease transfer students' transition into campus life.
- **Con:** Gaps in credit acceptance and poor integration efforts from the university.
- **News Angle:** Step-by-step guide on transfer process and orientation resources.

4. Working Off-Campus: Why On-Campus Jobs Don't Cut It

- **Pro:** Off-campus work offers higher pay, flexibility, and broader skill development.
- **Con:** Tough commutes, scheduling conflicts, and less academic integration add stress.
- **News Angle:** Local employment statistics, typical wages, and campus job openings.

5. The Frustrating Experience of Buying a Car from a Dealership

- **Angle:** Explore modern alternatives like online purchasing through Amazon and others.

Sustainability & Environment

1. Sustainability at USC: Real Commitment or Marketing Spin?

- **Pro:** Applaud new eco-friendly buildings, recycling initiatives, and campus-wide events.
- **Con:** Efforts remain superficial, ignoring larger systemic environmental issues.
- **News Angle:** Official carbon footprint reports and quotes from sustainability officers.

2. EV Infrastructure on Campus

- **Angle:** The number of EVs is increasing but infrastructure is lacking. How is USC failing to address this? Tie into the new battery facility, nuclear partnership, and increasing number of students buying EVs.

3. The New Battery Facility

- **Angle:** It's being built on the site of a failed green energy project from 2006. Are we repeating the mistakes of the past?

4. USC's Nuclear Partnership

- **Angle:** Why don't we have nuclear reactors on campus? A theoretical argument about the benefits, acknowledging the technical challenges.

Academic Integrity

1. Cheating Culture: An Unspoken Reality

- **Pro:** With better teaching methods and open resources, cheating would naturally decline.
- **Con:** Online tools and performance pressures drive more students to dishonest practices.
- **News Angle:** University honor code statistics including violations and disciplinary measures.

Diversity & Inclusion

1. Diversity Initiatives: Reaching the Right Students?

- **Pro:** Praise the visible growth of programs supporting underrepresented groups.
- **Con:** Efforts are more about optics and less about substantial institutional change.
- **News Angle:** Program funding levels, enrollment statistics, and upcoming inclusivity events.